

foundation of fear. Remember what the Bible teaches us: perfect love casts out all fear.”

“But I don’t want to dictate to Andrea,” Bill argued. However, even as he said it, he knew somewhere deep inside that what Mike had said was right. He did fear losing Andrea, and that was his prime motivation the weekend they eloped. He had seen the foolishness of what they were doing even from the beginning, but he didn’t have the courage to tell her no.

“I don’t mean that you should dictate to your wife, Bill. She is to be your equal partner. But you must accept that God’s plan for the husband is for him to take responsibility for his family—not follow his wife as if on a leash. That hasn’t happened with you yet, but it will if you allow it. Andrea has the stronger personality and will tend to set the pace.”

“Wait a minute. You’re making me sound like I want to wear the pants in the family,” Andrea protested.

“I don’t believe you do, Andrea. But you need to realize that you have a more dominant personality and that you must learn to control it.”

“Is that the second problem then?” she asked meekly.

“No, the second problem you need to deal with is your extravagant attitude toward money,” Mike said bluntly.

“What do you mean?” Andrea objected. “I don’t think I’m extravagant. I’ve never wasted money before this.”

“But Andrea, you never had the opportunity before,” Mike replied. “From what you said, I suspect that your dad ran your home and doled out the money he wanted you to have. And he was probably pretty cautious with his money, wasn’t he?”

“Well, yeah,” Andrea agreed. “But I never thought of myself as extravagant.”

“Some of the spending was ignorance about credit cards. But when the totals come to five thousand dollars, it usually goes far beyond just simple ignorance,” Mr. McKenna said. “Some people